Daniel girls overwhelm Seneca
By Caleb James
For The Journal

CENTRAL — The Daniel High School girls basketball team continued its dominant run through Region II 4A on Tuesday night, rolling to a 66-26 win over Seneca behind a strong offense defensive pressure from start to finish.

Ranked No. 5 in Class 4A, Daniel (17-1, 6-0) placed nine players in the scoring column and four in double digits, setting the tone early and never allowing Seneca to find their rhythm.

“I thought we played pretty well defensively,” Daniel’s head coach Cosandar Griffin said. “Our transition looked good on both offense and defense. We didn’t shoot the ball as well as I would’ve liked, but we finished around the rim with layups and transition points.”

Shala Williams led all scorers with 14 points, while Karmendee Hall added 13. Campbell Epting finished with 12 points, and Braelin Cumble chipped in 11 as the Tigers consistently pushed the pace.

Madeline McAlister added eight points, while Maria Bowers, Lila Mann, Janiyah Wilson and Milan Reed each scored two to round out Daniel’s offensive output.

Epting said the Tigers entered this rivalry matchup with one clear goal in mind

“This is obviously a very big rival for us,” Epting said. “We always want to go out there and dominate, have fun and give everything we’ve got. We only had one game this week, so we didn’t want to leave anything behind.”

For Seneca (6-13, 1-4), the Bobcats struggled to slow Daniel’s tempo but saw encouraging contributions from several players.

Savannah Weston led Seneca with nine points, while Miyana Chamberlain added seven. Freshman Jocelyn Chiles scored six points, Allana Taylor and Ja’nyce Floyd each had two, and Seneca worked to stay competitive against one of the region’s top teams.

“I think we had some players that played really hard,” Seneca head coach Anne-Hamilton LeRoy said. “Jocelyn Childs came ready to go, and Savannah Weston played very hard. Cameron Webb and Yanni Chamberlain, our seniors, also stepped up.”

LeRoy said the Bobcats’ focus moving forward is growth, particularly in mentality and approach.

“Our biggest thing is our mental approach to the game,” LeRoy said. “We may not win every single game, but we have to fight, compete and always play to win. If you don’t approach the game that way, you’re going to lose every time.”

Daniel 66, Seneca 26
DHS 19 21 22 4 — 66
SHS 5 7 16 18 — 26

Daniel (66) — Williams 14, Hall 13, Epting 12, Cumble 11, McAlister 8, Bowers 2, Mann 2, Wilson 2, Reed 2
Seneca (26) — Weston 9, Chamberlain 7, Chiles 6, Taylor 2, Floyd 2